

GenAI Forward Deployed Engineer

A little preparation can go a long way.
Successful candidates spent time writing code and reviewed the topics in this document. It is designed to support your interview preparation, but is not exhaustive.
Your recruiter is happy to help if you have any questions!

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Role Overview

As a GenAI Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE) at Google Cloud, you are an embedded builder who bridges the gap between frontier AI products and production-grade reality within customers. Unlike traditional advisory roles, you function as an "innovator-builder," moving beyond high-level architecture to code, debug, and jointly ship bespoke agentic solutions directly within the customer's environment.

This role is designed for high-agency engineers with a founder's mindset. You will tackle blockers to production including solving the integration complexities, data readiness issues, and state-management challenges that prevent AI from reaching enterprise-grade maturity. By embedding with strategic accounts, you serve a dual purpose: providing "white glove" deployment of complex AI systems and acting as a critical feedback loop, transforming real-world field insights into Google Cloud's future product roadmap.

Being at the forefront of expanding the boundaries of our GenAI technology, you will have close collaboration with our product team to eliminate obstacles and shape the future trajectory of our offerings.

To excel in this role, you should be able to thrive in ambiguous situations, as much of your work will be groundbreaking and uncharted. Additionally, you must be adept at disseminating the lessons learned to customers and internal Google teams.

Interview Process

Initial Call

Learn more about the role from a recruiter and share your experience.

Interview Preparation

Thoroughly review this guide along with the additional resources shared with you. Let your recruiter know if you have any questions prior to your interviews.

Interviews

The interview process includes 2 virtual interviews. A second person may dial in to shadow interviews to become a calibrated interviewer. **Do not use AI during the interviews.**

Role Related Knowledge (RRK) [60 minutes]

Coding [60 minutes]

Final Review

Our independent and calibrated management teams will review your interview feedback to finalize the hiring decision. Your recruiter will follow up with an update on the decision.

Interview Topics (RRK)

The RRK interview moves from high-level discovery to deep-dive architecture. Be prepared to discuss:

- **AI/ML Engineering:** How you integrate models into a functional system.
- **Operational Excellence:** Designing for reliability, resilience, and performance.
- **Security, Privacy & Compliance:** How you protect sensitive internal or client data (PII/Private info).
- **Scalability:** Thinking through the jump from 10,000 internal users to millions of external clients.
- **Performance & Costs Optimization:** Balancing system performance with resource management.

Generative AI Concepts - This team will be focusing primarily on GenAI tools and technologies, so it is critical to have a foundation in topics like: LLMs (training them, serving them, troubleshooting them, and their role in a customer's digital transformation), Natural Language Processing, and your experience working hands-on with GenAI models.

Application Development - You should be comfortable designing, building, testing, deploying, and articulating the value of a demo to a customer.

Consulting - Interviewers want to understand how you work with customers and partners: how you uncover and assess stakeholder needs through conversations in order to make recommendations.

Cloud Technology - Our interviews are not GCP specific, although it is recommended you familiarize yourself with the names of relevant GCP Cloud products. Questions will evaluate your general cloud knowledge, therefore answer these questions in the cloud platform you are most familiar with. However it is helpful to do some high-level research on GCP products and services, and our value proposition.

Troubleshooting - Interviewers are looking for a logical and structured approach to problem solving through distributed systems, network and web scenarios. Make sure you understand the questions and ask appropriate follow-up questions if you need clarification. A big part is finding out what the actual problem is and breaking it down into specifics. Check out [Life in App Engine Production](#) for a troubleshooting example.

Sample Question: Your marketing manager complains to you that the new company website is slow, what would you do?

System Design - System Design questions assess a candidate's ability to combine knowledge, theory, experience and judgement to solve a real-world engineering problem. Sample topics include distributed systems, designing a system under certain constraints, simplicity, limitations, robustness, and tradeoffs. Typically, these questions will start with a broad ask, and we're looking to see how you navigate that. Gather the appropriate amount of information by asking questions and use your judgement to decide when to start proposing a design. You should be able to talk through your decision making process and what the technical trade-offs are for different design decisions. [Prepare for Your Google Interview: Systems Design](#)

Interview Topics (Coding)

Coding - You will be coding in our static Google Virtual Interview Platform. This is not a live environment, but it does provide formatting/syntax highlighting. This format is intended for you to focus on your *process* versus *result*, so you will not be running or deploying the code. The goal of this interview is to understand your **proficiency in Python object oriented programming “OOP” language** and your **fundamental knowledge in software system design**. You will be expected to code 30-50 lines of code in Python.

See [Prepare for Your Google Interview: Coding](#) for a mock coding session in person, but keep in mind that you will be conducting this interview virtually on Google Meet.

Curious how to practice? We recommend practicing **intermediate to advanced problem-solving exercises** that focus on time and space complexity and touch on advanced computational logic.

Additional Recommendations:

1. You will be asked an open-ended question so be sure to ask clarifying questions & devise requirements aloud.
2. We encourage you to troubleshoot out loud with the interviewer as well as you work through the problem to showcase your problem solving skills in addition to coding fluency.
3. You will be asked to explain it in an algorithm.
4. You should not use pseudocode unless specifically instructed by your interviewer. (**Hint:** *Don't worry about getting it perfect, because time is limited. Consider starting with a solution that works and refine it throughout the interview. Ensure your code is “production-ready” by thoroughly considering corner cases and edge cases*).
5. Optimize the code, follow it with test cases and find any bugs.

Additional Resources

Supplementary Study Materials (Optional)

- [Google Cloud Skills Boost](#): Dive into any courses relevant to the technical domain.
- [Coursera Classes](#): You can access the course materials as part of the FREE AUDIT or purchase the entire class. Not sure where to start? Begin with our fundamentals training.
- [Tips to prepare for interviews](#)
- [Life at Google](#) *[YouTube Channel videos]*
- Google Cloud Services:
 - Check out the [Google Cloud Blog](#) to dive deeper into What's New, Product News, Solutions & Technologies.
 - Understand the value proposition of [Google Cloud](#), our customers/partners, and the trends within the cloud industry. Be able to describe [Google Cloud's AI/ML products](#) and [Gemini](#), Generative AI on [Vertex AI](#) and how you might discuss the benefits with customers.
 - Hear the latest product launches and customer stories at [Google Cloud Next '26](#) (April 2026).
 - Learn from [Google Cloud's Tech team](#).

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